



YOUR EVERYDAY SHOE MADE BETTER

My redesign addresses the impacts of materials used in Converse through the substitution of cotton and natural rubber with mycelium fabrics and nitrile cork, offsetting energy consumption and pollutants from before manufacturing to the afterlife.

Mycelium can grow from waste materials like sawdust, glass pieces, and rice hulls offering a stronger alternative, similar to leather but entirely biodegradable without toxins. It's land and energy efficient as it grows densely, can be grown indoors and doesn't require much water. Its structure is fibrous and absorbent, allowing it to easily accept natural dyes and pigments, allowing for a wide range of personalization. Mycelium fabrics are generally lighter and more energy-efficient to ship than cotton due to their lower density, which reduces shipping weight and transport-related carbon emissions. Mycelium fabrics are grown in facilities primarily in the US, allowing its production to take place with stricter labour laws and removing the shipment between manufacturer and distributor.

Nitrile cork is a blend of cork and rubber, cork typically at least 35% of the makeup. It's a renewable, biodegradable, and carbon-negative material harvested by stripping the bark of cork oak trees without harming them. Often, using discarded cork from other products. Cork can also add additional cushioning, save weight, and make the soles more comfortable than traditional rubber soles.

People are more likely to want to consume and invest in things that align with their values. This is called value-driven consumption or impact investing, and people are often willing to pay more if so. A company of this scale implementing a redesign such as this, without challenging the iconic integrity of their original shoes, would pave the way for more recognition into mycelium materials and its beneficial uses.